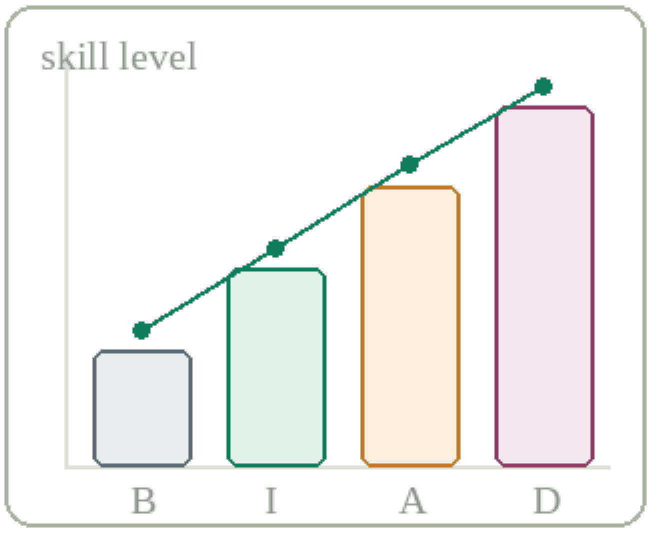
Sheet1 · A1

The Excel **roadmap**

from basic to advanced



A structured path through 30 skills across four levels — built for anyone learning Excel with data analysis as the destination.

🌱 **Basic** 🔗 **Intermediate** ⚡ **Advanced** 🏆 **Data analyst**

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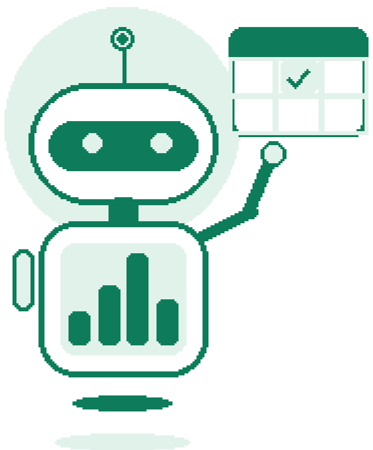
30 skills · 4 levels · one workbook 📘

Why this roadmap works

✅ Every level builds on the last — nothing learned out of order.
🎯 Each skill maps to a real outcome, not just a function name.
📈 Ends where the job actually starts: Power BI & SQL handoff.



swipe for the full topic list →

🌱 Level 1 — Basic

Foundations

7 topics

Get comfortable moving around a workbook and doing simple calculations without breaking anything.

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1 🧭 **Interface & navigation**

Ribbon, sheets, workbooks, cell addressing.

`Ctrl+arrows` `Ctrl+F`

→ Move fast without touching the mouse for everything.

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2 🎨 **Data entry & formatting**

Number formats, alignment, cell styles, borders.

`Format cells`

→ Data looks clean and reads correctly.

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3 ➕ **Basic formulas & operators**

Arithmetic and the core aggregate functions.

`SUM` `AVERAGE` `COUNT` `MIN/MAX`

→ Every spreadsheet task starts here.

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4 📌 **Cell references**

Relative, absolute and mixed references.

`$A$1` `F4`

→ Formulas copy correctly across rows & columns.

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5 🔽 **Sorting & filtering**

Single/multi-level sort, AutoFilter.

`Sort & Filter`

→ Find and order rows that matter in seconds.

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6 📊 **Basic charts**

Bar, line, pie — picking the right one.

`Insert > Chart`

→ Numbers become a picture people understand fast.

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7 🖨️ **Page setup & printing**

Print area, freeze panes, headers/footers.

`Freeze panes`

→ Reports are shareable outside the file itself.

🔗 Level 2 — Intermediate

8 topics

Logic & lookups

Move from static numbers to formulas that make decisions and pull data from elsewhere.

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8 🧠 **Logical functions**

Conditional decisions, nested logic.

`IF` `IFS` `AND/OR`

→ Formulas respond differently to different data.

9 🔍 **Lookup functions**

Pulling matching data from another table.

`VLOOKUP` `INDEX/MATCH`

→ The single most-used analyst skill.

10 ✂️ **Text functions**

Splitting, joining, cleaning text values.

`LEFT/RIGHT` `TRIM` `CONCAT`

→ Messy exported data becomes usable columns.

11 📅 **Date & time functions**

Calculating durations and business days.

`DATEDIF` `NETWORKDAYS`

→ Tenure & deadline math stops being manual.

12 🚦 **Conditional formatting**

Highlighting values based on rules.

`Color scales` `Icon sets`

→ Outliers jump out without extra formulas.

13 ✅ **Data validation**

Dropdowns, input rules, error alerts.

`Data > Validation`

→ Bad data is stopped at entry, not cleaned later.

14 🧮 **PivotTables & PivotCharts**

Summarizing large datasets by category.

`Insert > PivotTable`

→ Thousands of rows collapse into an answer.

15 🎯 **What-if analysis**

Testing scenarios and solving backwards.

`Goal Seek` `Data Tables`

→ Answer: what input gets me this result?

⚡ Level 3 — Advanced

Modeling & automation

8 topics

Handle bigger datasets, build real data models, and stop repeating manual work.

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16 ⚡ **Modern lookups & arrays**

Faster, more flexible than VLOOKUP.

`XLOOKUP` `Array formulas`

→ Lookups get simpler, faster, less fragile.

17 ➗ **Conditional aggregation**

Summing/counting with multiple criteria.

`SUMIFS` `COUNTIFS`

→ Multi-condition reporting, no helper columns.

18 🔄 **Power Query**

Importing, cleaning, reshaping data at scale.

`Get & Transform`

→ Cleaning becomes repeatable, not a one-off.

19 🗃️ **Power Pivot & data model**

Linking multiple tables by relationships.

`Manage relationships`

→ Analyze millions of rows across many tables.

20 🧩 **Intro to DAX**

Writing calculated measures for the model.

`CALCULATE` `Measures`

→ The bridge skill straight into Power BI.

21 🎛️ **Advanced PivotTables**

Slicers, timelines, calculated fields.

`Slicers`

→ Pivots become interactive, not static.

22 🤖 **Macros & VBA basics**

Recording and writing simple automation.

`Macro recorder` `VBA`

→ Repetitive tasks run in one click.

23 📋 **Dashboard design**

KPI cards, dynamic charts, layout.

`Named ranges`

→ Output looks like something worth opening.

🏆 Level 4 — Data analyst

Specialization

7 topics

The skills that separate someone who “knows Excel” from someone who can do the job.

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24 🧹 Data cleaning at scale

M language basics in Power Query.

`Power Query M`

→ Clean data too messy for formulas alone.

25 📐 Statistical functions

Trend, correlation, forecasting basics.

`STDEV` `CORREL` `FORECAST`

→ Back a claim with a number, not just a chart.

26 🏗️ Advanced DAX & modeling

Time intelligence, star schemas.

`Time intelligence`

→ Build the model a BI team would ship.

27 🖥️ Interactive dashboards

Form controls, dynamic named ranges.

`Form controls`

→ Stakeholders explore data, not just view it.

28 ⚙️ Deeper automation

VBA, Office Scripts, Power Automate.

`Office Scripts`

→ Recurring reports build & send themselves.

29 📣 Data storytelling

Framing a finding so a decision follows.

`Executive summary`

→ Analysis only matters if someone acts on it.

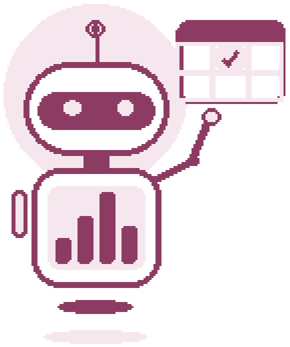
30 🚪 Beyond Excel

Handing off to Power BI and SQL.

`Power BI` `SQL`

→ Know when a spreadsheet isn't the right tool.

👑



You made it
through the workbook

Basic to advanced, 30 skills, one continuous path. The gap between someone who knows Excel and a working data analyst is this list — done in order.

🌱 **Basic**	**7 topics**
🔗 **Intermediate**	**8 topics**
⚡ **Advanced**	**8 topics**
🏆 **Data analyst**	**7 topics**

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3 tips before you start

1. Don't skip levels — half the “advanced” tricks are just basics stacked together.
2. Practice on messy real data, not a clean tutorial file.
3. Learn the why, not just the keystroke — it's what makes it stick.

> **A NOTE ON MASTERY**
> *The best analysts aren't the ones who know every function — they're the ones who know which one to reach for.*

Save this for your next Excel deep-dive.

Share it with someone learning Excel right now.

Comment your current level — 1, 2, 3 or 4.